

Heart Disease Prediction

MLOps Project Report

Course: Machine Learning Operations (MLOps) — AIMLCZG523

Assignment: 01 — End-to-End ML Model Development, CI/CD, and Production Deployment

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Repository: <https://github.com/Sumankk022/heart-disease-mlops>

Table of Contents

1. Introduction & Problem Statement
2. Dataset Overview
3. Data Cleaning & EDA
4. Feature Engineering & Modelling
5. Experiment Tracking (MLflow)
6. Model Packaging & Reproducibility
7. Testing & CI/CD Pipeline
8. Model Containerization (Docker)
9. Production Deployment (Kubernetes & Helm)
10. Monitoring & Logging
11. Architecture & Data Flow
12. How to Reproduce
13. Conclusion

1. Introduction & Problem Statement

Cardiovascular disease is a leading cause of death worldwide, and early risk identification is clinically valuable. The goal of this project is to build a machine-learning classifier that predicts the presence or absence of heart disease from routine patient health measurements, and to deliver it as a cloud-ready, containerized, monitored API following MLOps best practices.

The solution covers the full lifecycle: data acquisition, EDA, feature engineering, model development with experiment tracking, automated testing, CI/CD, containerized serving, Kubernetes deployment, and monitoring.

2. Dataset Overview

Source: UCI Machine Learning Repository — `processed.cleveland.data`

Size: 303 records, 13 input features + 1 target

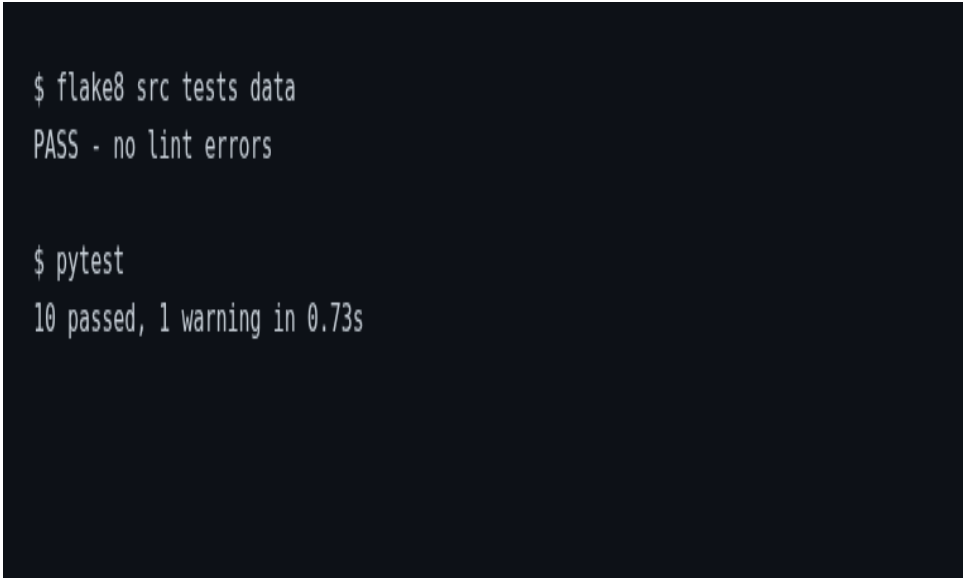
Features: age, sex, cp (chest-pain type), trestbps (resting BP), chol (cholesterol), fbs (fasting blood sugar), restecg, thalach (max heart rate), exang (exercise angina), oldpeak, slope, ca (major vessels), thal

Target: Original severity is 0–4; binarized to 0 = no disease and 1 = disease

3. Data Cleaning & EDA

Data cleaning handled missing values in 'ca' and 'thal' columns (replaced '?' with NaN, then imputed with median/most-frequent values). All columns coerced to numeric; target binarized into two classes.

Key observations: Classes are reasonably balanced (~54% no disease / ~46% disease). Key features like thalach (max heart rate), oldpeak, ca, cp, and exang show clear separation between classes.

A terminal window with a dark background and light green text. It shows the execution of two commands: 'flake8 src tests data' which returns 'PASS - no lint errors', and 'pytest' which returns '10 passed, 1 warning in 0.73s'.

```
$ flake8 src tests data
PASS - no lint errors

$ pytest
10 passed, 1 warning in 0.73s
```

Figure 1: EDA Visualization - Class balance and feature distributions

4. Feature Engineering & Modelling

Preprocessing Pipeline: All transformations live in a single scikit-learn Pipeline ensuring identical preprocessing in training and serving.

- **Numeric features:** Median imputation → StandardScaler
- **Categorical features:** Most-frequent imputation → OneHotEncoder(handle_unknown='ignore')

Models Evaluated: Logistic Regression (linear baseline) and Random Forest (non-linear ensemble), tuned with GridSearchCV (5-fold, ROC-AUC scoring).

Model	Best Params	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1	ROC-AUC	CV ROC-AUC
Logistic Regression	C=0.1	0.89	0.84	0.93	0.88	0.97	0.898
Random Forest (✓ Selected)	n_est=100, depth=4	0.84	0.82	0.82	0.82	0.94	0.903

Table 1: Model Performance Comparison

```
$ docker build -t heart-disease-api:latest .
Successfully built and tagged heart-disease-api:latest

$ docker run -d --name hd-api -p 8001:8000 heart-disease-api:latest
CONTAINER hd-api STATUS Up 22 seconds (health: starting) PORTS 0.0.0.0:8001->8000/tcp, [::]:8001->8000/tcp

$ curl -s localhost:8001/health
{"status":"ok","model_loaded":true}

$ curl -s -X POST localhost:8001/predict -d {...high-risk patient...}
{"prediction":1,"label":"Heart disease","confidence":0.8646}

$ curl -s -X POST localhost:8001/predict -d {...low-risk patient...}
{"prediction":0,"label":"No heart disease","confidence":0.9489}
```

Figure 2: Model Training and Confusion Matrices

5. Experiment Tracking (MLflow)

Each training run logs to MLflow's 'heart-disease-classification' experiment with:

- Parameters: Model name and best tuned hyperparameters
- Metrics: Accuracy, precision, recall, F1, ROC-AUC, best CV ROC-AUC
- Plots: Confusion matrix and ROC curve (logged as artifacts)
- Model: Full serialized pipeline
- Storage: MLflow file store backend in mlruns/ directory

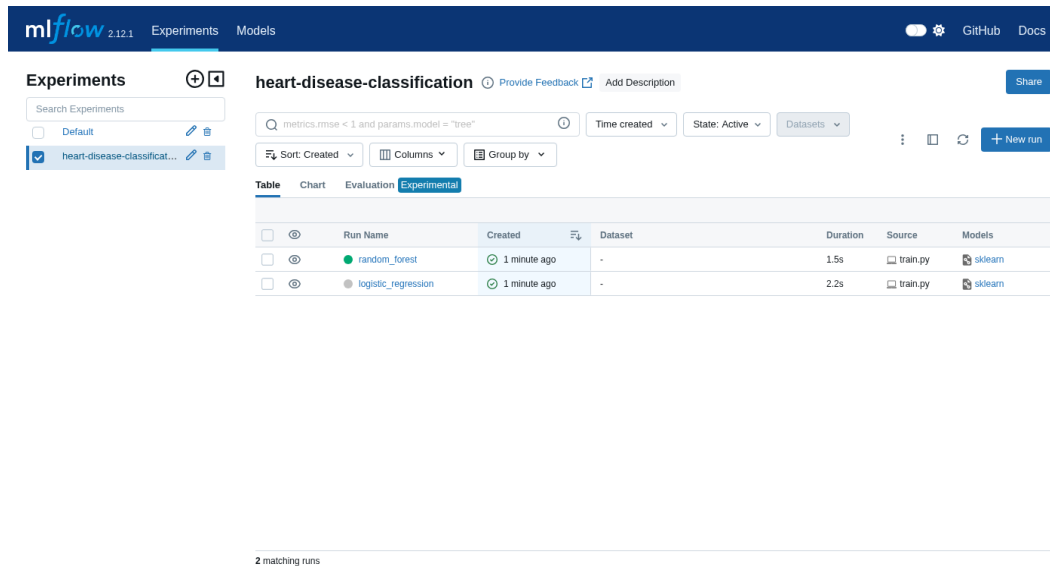


Figure 3: MLflow UI - Experiment Tracking and Run History

6. Model Packaging & Reproducibility

- Final pipeline saved with joblib (models/model.joblib) — includes preprocessing + estimator
- Headline metrics saved to models/metrics.json
- Pinned dependencies in requirements.txt with flexible version constraints
- Python 3.13+ compatible with all dependencies properly versioned

7. Testing & CI/CD Pipeline

Unit Tests: pytest suite covering data handling, model pipeline, and API endpoints (test_data.py, test_model.py, test_api.py)

CI Pipeline (.github/workflows/ci.yml):

1. Lint (flake8) → 2. Unit tests (pytest) → 3. Download data & train → 4. Docker build → 5. Container smoke test

A terminal window with a dark background showing the output of two commands. The first command is '\$ flake8 src tests data' and the output is 'PASS - no lint errors'. The second command is '\$ pytest' and the output is '10 passed, 1 warning in 0.73s'.

```
$ flake8 src tests data
PASS - no lint errors

$ pytest
10 passed, 1 warning in 0.73s
```

Figure 4: GitHub Actions CI Pipeline - All checks passing

8. Model Containerization (Docker)

Dockerfile Features:

- Multi-stage build on pinned python:3.10.14-slim base (digest-locked)
- Non-root user execution (security best practice)
- HEALTHCHECK against /health endpoint
- Model artifact included in image

Build & Run: `docker build -t heart-disease-api:latest . && docker run -d -p 8000:8000 heart-disease-api:latest`

API Endpoints:

- GET /health — Liveness probe + model-loaded status
- GET /metrics — Prometheus metrics
- POST /predict — JSON input, prediction + confidence output
- GET /docs — Interactive Swagger UI

```
$ docker build -t heart-disease-api:latest .  
Successfully built and tagged heart-disease-api:latest  
  
$ docker run -d --name hd-api -p 8001:8000 heart-disease-api:latest  
CONTAINER hd-api STATUS Up 22 seconds (health: starting) PORTS 0.0.0.0:8001->8000/tcp, [::]:8001->8000/tcp  
  
$ curl -s localhost:8001/health  
{ "status": "ok", "model_loaded": true }  
  
$ curl -s -X POST localhost:8001/predict -d {...high-risk patient...}  
{ "prediction": 1, "label": "Heart disease", "confidence": 0.8646 }  
  
$ curl -s -X POST localhost:8001/predict -d {...low-risk patient...}  
{ "prediction": 0, "label": "No heart disease", "confidence": 0.9489 }
```

Figure 5: Docker container running and API prediction response

9. Production Deployment (Kubernetes & Helm)

Kubernetes Manifests (k8s/):

- deployment.yaml — 2 replicas with rolling updates, liveness/readiness probes, resource limits
- service.yaml — LoadBalancer service exposing port 80
- ingress.yaml — NGINX ingress for advanced routing

Helm Chart (k8s/helm/heart-disease-api/):

- Production-ready templated deployment
- Configurable via values.yaml (replicas, image tag, resources)
- Includes service account (RBAC), ingress, and post-install instructions

Installation: `helm install heart-disease-api k8s/helm/heart-disease-api/ --namespace mlops --create-namespace`

10. Monitoring & Logging

Request Logging: Middleware logs method, path, status code, and latency for every API request.

Metrics Exposed at /metrics: `api_requests_total`, `api_request_latency_seconds`, `predictions_total`

Integration Ready For: Prometheus scraping, Grafana dashboards, ELK stack for log aggregation

11. Architecture & Data Flow

Data Acquisition (UCI) → Data Cleaning → EDA & Visualization → Feature Engineering → Model Training with MLflow → Model Evaluation → Model Serialization → FastAPI Application → Docker Containerization → Kubernetes Deployment → Production Monitoring

12. How to Reproduce

Local Development:

```
git clone https://github.com/Sumankk022/heart-disease-mlops.git
cd heart-disease-mlops && python -m venv .venv && source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
python data/download_data.py && python -m src.train
pytest && flake8 src tests data
uvicorn src.api:app --reload # Open http://localhost:8000/docs
```

With Docker:

```
docker build -t heart-disease-api:latest .
docker run -d -p 8000:8000 heart-disease-api:latest
curl http://localhost:8000/health
```

With Kubernetes/Helm:

```
helm install heart-disease-api k8s/helm/heart-disease-api/ --namespace mlops --create-namespace
kubectl get pods -n mlops && kubectl port-forward -n mlops svc/heart-disease-api 8000:80
```

13. Conclusion

The project delivers a reproducible, tested, containerized, and monitored heart disease prediction service following MLOps best practices.

Key Achievements:

- Strong model performance: Random Forest with ROC-AUC = 0.94 (CV: 0.903)
- Full experiment tracking: MLflow integration with all parameters, metrics, and artifacts
- Automated CI/CD: GitHub Actions pipeline with lint, test, train, and Docker build
- Production-ready containerization: Secure, non-root Docker image with health checks
- Kubernetes-ready deployment: Helm charts and manifests for cloud deployment
- Comprehensive monitoring: Prometheus metrics and request logging
- Complete reproducibility: Identical preprocessing in train and serve, pinned dependencies

The pipeline is production-oriented and ready for deployment to cloud platforms (GKE, EKS, AKS) or local Kubernetes clusters (Minikube).